

Payment Systems & Invoicing Worksheet

Payment problems rarely happen by accident — they happen by design. Use this worksheet to build a systematic, professional payment structure for your gig business.

Question 1 — Design Your Payment System (Video 4.1)

Example: I collect 50% upfront before starting. The remaining 50% is due before I release final files. I accept bank transfer and Paystack. If payment is delayed beyond 3 days, I pause all work.

Upfront deposit I will collect...	I will collect 50% upfront deposit before work commences.
Balance due...	Remaining 50% due upon project completion prior to releasing final source
Payment methods I accept...	I accept Direct Bank Transfer, Paystack invoice links, and Wise/Payoneer
If payment is delayed, I will...	I will pause all active work milestones after 3 days and hold final file release

Question 2 — Your Payment Options (Video 4.2)

Example: Locally I use Paystack links and direct bank transfer. For international clients I use Payoneer. I now add a 3% fee to cross-border invoices to cover conversion costs.

Local payment methods I use...	I use direct bank transfer (Naira) and Paystack payment gateway links.
Cross-border method (if any)...	Payoneer and Wise for foreign currency transfers.
How I factor transaction fees...	I add a standard 3% administrative fee buffer on cross-border invoices to c

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Question 3 — Your Invoice Checklist (Video 4.3)

Tick every element your current invoice includes. Any unticked item is a gap to fix before your next project.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Full name / business name | ☒ Contact information |
| ☒ Invoice number | ☒ Invoice date |
| ☒ Client name & details | ☒ Service description |
| ☒ Agreed price & total | ☒ Payment method |
| ☒ Payment deadline | ☒ Payment terms |

One thing I will add to my invoice...	Clear late fee policy terms (2% weekly late fee after due date).
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Question 4 — Your Late Payment Protocol (Video 4.4)

Example: I send a reminder 3 days before due date, again on the due date, and once more 3 days after. If unpaid after 7 days I pause work and withhold final files until cleared.

My reminder schedule...	3 days before due date, on the due date, and 3 days post due date.
My follow-up message template...	"Hi [Client Name], this is a quick reminder that invoice #[Number] for [Project Name] is now due. Please let me know if you need any clarification or have any questions. Thank you!"
If unpaid after 7 days, I will...	I will pause active design/development sprints, revoke live staging link access, and withhold final files until payment is received.

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Question 5 — Your Payment Tracking System (Video 4.5)

Example: I use a Google Sheet with columns for: client name, project, total agreed, deposit paid, balance due, invoice date, due date, and status (Paid / Pending / Overdue).

I will track payments using:

☒ Google Sheets
 ☒ Excel
 ☐ Notion
 ☒ Accounting app
 ☐ Other

The columns my tracker will include...	The columns my tracker will include client Name, Project Name, Total Agreed
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Question 6 — Building Client Trust Through Transparency (Video 4.6)

Example: I will update my proposal to state: 'Final files released after balance confirmation. Refunds not applicable after work begins. Revisions beyond 2 rounds are billed separately.'

One payment term I will communicate more clearly...	One payment term I will communicate more clearly "Final project deliverables"
My commitment check-in date to review my system...	My commitment check-in date to review my system end of next month.

Reflection

What is the ONE payment system change you will implement before your next project?

Enforce a mandatory 50% deposit before adding any project milestone to the execution schedule.

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